

Seawall height in Lauderdale-by-the-Sea

The elevation your city requires, the datum it is measured in, and the section of code that says so.

LAUDERDALE-BY-THE-SEA • BROWARD COUNTY

5.0

 ft NAVD88

New, substantially repaired or substantially rehabilitated seawalls in Lauderdale-By-The-Sea must reach at least 5.0 ft NAVD88. Applications filed before 1 Jan 2035 can be approved at 4.0 ft NAVD88 if the wall is designed to be raised to 5.0 ft by 2050. The town code sets no maximum seawall height.

The detail

MINIMUM	5.0 ft NAVD88 - Code Sec. 9-63(a)
INTERIM	Applications submitted before 1 Jan 2035 may be permitted at 4.0 ft NAVD88 if designed and constructed to accommodate 5.0 ft NAVD88 by 1 Jan 2050 - Sec. 9-63(a)
APPLIES TO	new tidal flood barriers and substantial repair/rehab; not oceanfront seaward of the CCCL - Sec. 9-61
ENFORCEMENT	failure to maintain is a civil infraction under Ch. 6.5; repairs due within 365 days - Sec. 9-63(b)
DOCKS	dock deck may not be higher than the abutting seawall - Sec. 30-311(3)
ADOPTED	Ord. No. 2022-01, 22 Feb 2022 - Sec. 9-60 to 9-64
SETBACKS FROM THE WALL	In the RD-10 duplex district, a lot backing onto the Intracoastal or inland waterways needs a 15 ft rear setback from the seawall; on RM-25 lots 60 ft wide or less south of Pine Avenue, a side abutting the waterway is set back at least 12 ft from the seawall - Sec. 30-221(c)(3), 30-242(b)(2)
WHO ADMINISTERS	The Town Engineer is designated floodplain administrator under Ch. 9 - Sec. 9-14
SELF-RAISING BARRIERS	Barriers that rise on their own ahead of high tides are permitted, as long as the automation does not depend on someone operating it every day - Sec. 9-63(f)

Where this comes from: Lauderdale-By-The-Sea Code of Ordinances Ch. 9, Art. XI, Sec. 9-63 (Ord. No. 2022-01); Sec. 9-14; ULDR Secs. 30-221, 30-242

Before you call a contractor

1 Know your datum

A height means nothing without the datum it is measured from. NAVD88 and MLW are different reference points and the same wall gives different numbers in each. Ask which one any quoted elevation refers to.

2 Get the existing elevation surveyed

You cannot tell whether a wall meets the requirement by looking at it. A surveyor shooting the top of the cap settles it in an hour.

3 Ask what triggers the requirement

Most cities only apply the minimum to new walls or to substantial repair. What counts as substantial is defined differently in each city, and it is usually a percentage of length or of cost.

4 Ask about building higher now

Several cities require a wall built below the final figure to be engineered so it can be raised later. Doing it once is cheaper than doing it twice.